



The Best Places to Eat Pierogi

Zapiecek Polskie Pierogarnia inexpensive

Pierogi were a mainstay during Poland's years of Communist rule, and while a lot has changed in both Poland and *pierogi* fillings since then, cheap and cheerful *pierogarnie* (places serving *pierogi*) still seem to have the best dumplings. A quintessential example is Zapiecek in the Old Town and, to the eternal gratitude of party people and denizens of the dark, it's open around the clock. Nothing fancy here – Zapiecek is self-service with a half-dozen tables and garden seating in the warmer months. But the legions of locals frequenting the joint are here for the finest handmade *pierogi* in town, rolled and pinched before their very noses. It's a quintessential Kraków experience and one not to be missed.

Ulica Sławkowska 32, Kraków; open 24 hrs daily; www.zapiecek.eu

Also in Kraków

If you're looking for *pierogi* in more stylish surrounds, just cross the street to **U Babci Maliny** (www.kuchniaubacimaliny.pl; *inexpensive*), where the *pierogi* are fried, not boiled, and served on a real trencher – a piece of bread as a plate. The decor is faux-folksy, with rough-hewn wooden walls and sheepskins, but cozy and fun.

Also in Poland

One of Warsaw's finest restaurants, **Gessler Restauracja U Kucharzy** (www.gessler.pl; *expensive*) serves peerless *pierogi* along with more ambitious dishes in a delightful restaurant set inside the kitchen of a elegant old hotel.

Around the World

The Polish diaspora ensures that excellent *pierogi* can be sampled in many corners of the world, and notably in London. Gessler of Warsaw has taken over Daquise, the longest-established independent Polish restaurant in London and favorite of Polish emigrés. It now trades as **Gessler Restauracja at Daquise** (www.gesslerlondon.com; *moderate*) in spruced-up but still very homey surroundings, just around the corner from the South Kensington tube station. For something even more stylish, head north along Exhibition Road to **Ognisko** (www.ognisko.com; *expensive*), a clubby place filled with oil paintings, chandeliers, and mirrors and overlooking a verdant square. It serves a variety of Polish specialties, including *pierogi z mie sem lub pierogi ruskie* (*pierogi* stuffed with meat or cheese and potatoes) and *watróbka ciele ca nieborów* (calf's liver with Polish smoked bacon, tomato, and mustard sauce).